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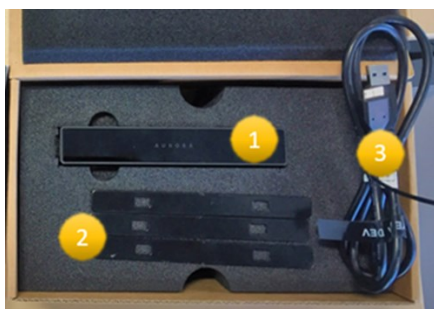
Setting up Aurora or AI-X in iMotions

How to set up and connect Smart Eye Aurora or AI-X Eye Trackers to iMotions.

- Initial setup of the Smart Eye Aurora and AI-X (required any time a new monitor/eye tracker is used).
 1. Installation of the Smart Eye Tracker software ([Smart Eye Tracker installer](#) - version 13.0.1)
 2. Hardware setup
 3. Creating a 'New setup' in the Smart Eye Setup Tool
 4. Connecting the eye tracker to iMotions.
- After initial setup, you can disconnect/reconnect your eye tracker USB cable to the iMotions computer, where it will be detected in iMotions (as indicated in the iMotions Eye Tracker Settings and Widget).
- A new setup (step 3) must be made if Windows Display Settings are changed or a different eye tracker model is used (i.e. Aurora vs. AI-X).
- Windows 10 (or newer) is required

Included Hardware

1. Smart Eye Aurora or AI-X eye tracker device
2. Mount (attached to eye tracking display screen)
3. USB C or USB 3 cable (Aurora include detachable cable, AI-X includes an attached USB-3)



Smart Eye Aurora (left) and AI-X (right)

Smart Eye Tracker Installation

Download and install the Smart Eye Tracker software on your iMotions computer. During installation, we recommend using the 'Options' to add the software to your Windows Path and Firewall Exceptions.

Note: If you have Smart Eye software version 9.0 or older, you will first need uninstall this version before updating/installing a new version (go to *Control Panel - Programs - Programs and features* - the 'Smart Eye' software and uninstall).

Click [here](#) to download a video

Hardware and Software Setup

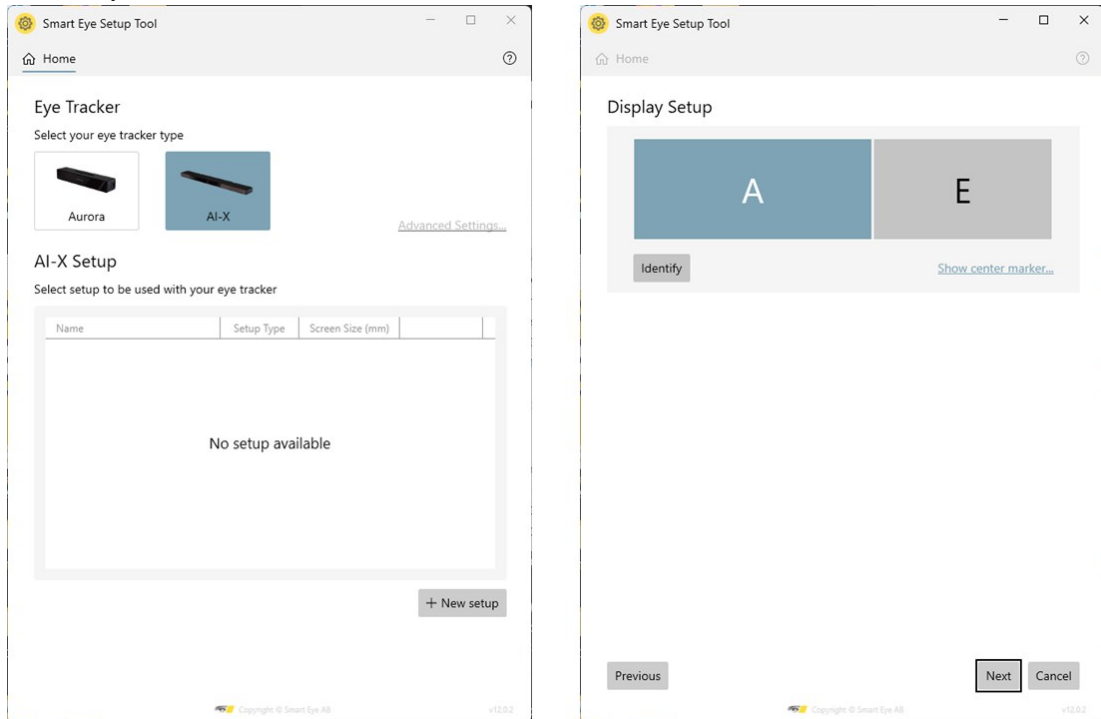
For standard Display setup, the Smart Eye Setup Tool is used to show a center marker at the bottom of your eye tracking display to assist with placement of your Smart Eye Aurora/AI-X Mount. Once the mount is attached, you would need to create a 'setup' and use the Smart Eye Setup Tool to indicate the device size relative to your display.

For [Phone setup](#) and [Tripod setup](#) (e.g. with Larger screens), please refer to the linked Help Center articles.

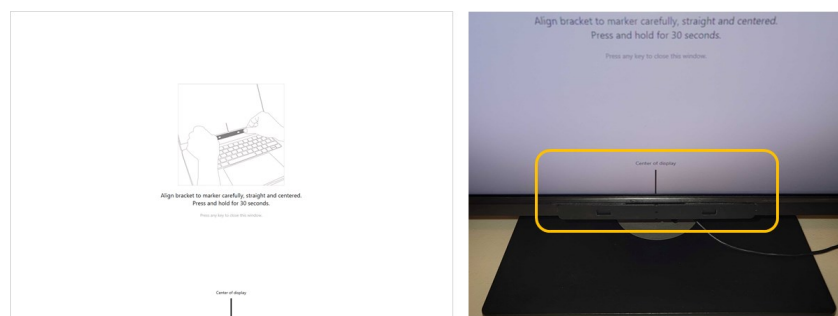
Recommended (before initial setup): Clean area where mount will be placed, removing any dust, debris, oils, etc.

1. Open the Smart Eye Setup Tool (with the Windows Start Menu/Search or desktop icon)
2. Select your eye tracker model: Aurora or AI-X
3. Click +New setup and select the display monitor, where eye tracking stimuli will be shown.

4. Click Show center maker to display the 'Center of display' mark and mount placement instructions



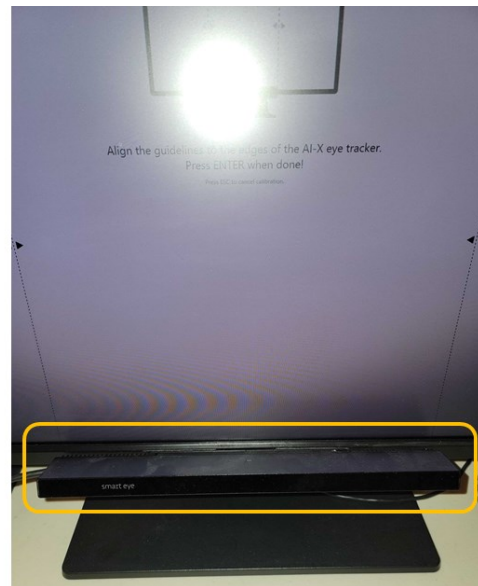
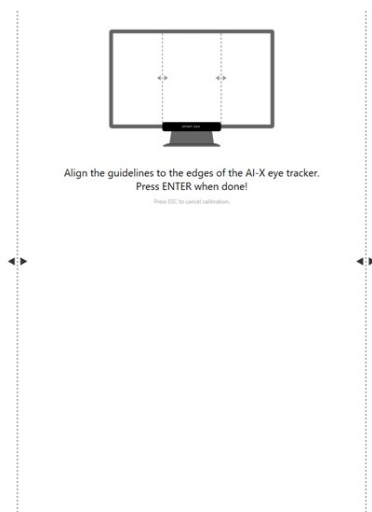
5. Attach the Mount with the adhesive strips as described in the [Smart Eye Manuals](#) (at the bottom of this article).
- The eye tracker mount should be flat and stable at the bottom-center of your monitor border/bezel.
 - The eye tracker mount should be a minimal distance below the display but should not occlude the display
 - The screen bezel (or frame around the display area) should be at least 14 mm for your mount.



Smart Eye Setup Tool 'Center of display' (left) and Mount Placement (right)

6. Attach the Eye Tracker Device to the Mount. The square pegs (on the back of the device) should align and fit securely in the square slots (in the mounting plate).
- Ensure that the front of the device is stable and visible/unobstructed with the front/glass surface directed towards the respondent's face/eye location.

- b. Ensure that the cable/connection can reach your iMotions computer.
7. Press any key to proceed and open the setup calibration in Smart Eye Setup Tool (by pressing 'Next')
8. Follow the instructions to Align the guidelines to the edges of the eye tracker then press Enter to proceed.
9. Enter setup name (for this monitor/dimensions/setup) then click Finish.
10. You can confirm/choose setups then close the Smart Eye Setup Tool.
Note: Additional setups are required for each different monitors and Windows Display Settings.



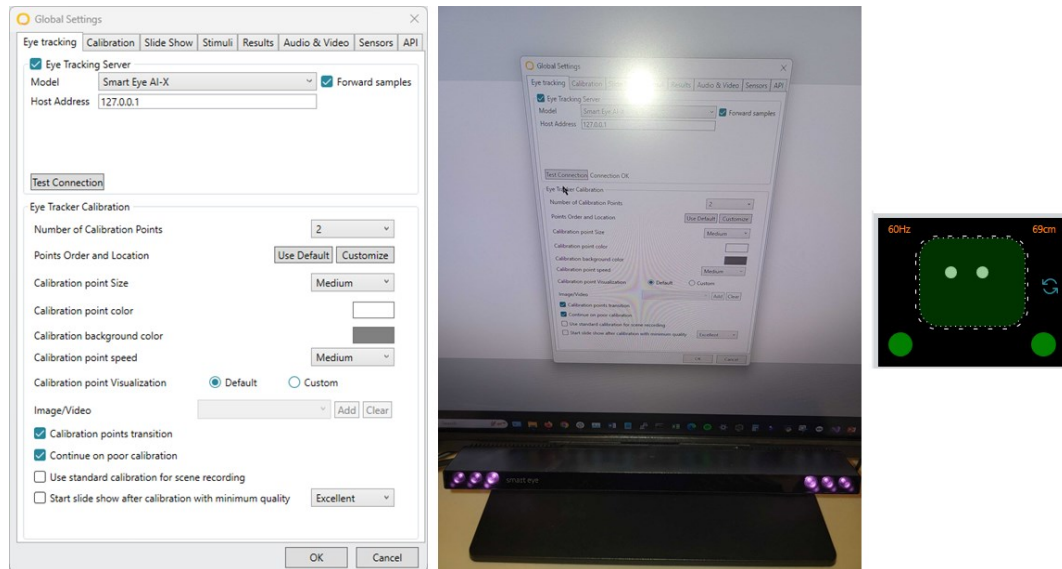
Smart Eye Setup Tool Eye Tracker setup calibration screen (left) and placement (right)

Connecting the Eye Tracker to iMotions

After initial hardware setup and the correct setup has been created/selected in Smart Eye Setup Tool, you can plug your eye tracker into the iMotions computer and finish connecting the eye tracker in iMotions Settings. Note: Smart Eye Setup Tool should be closed to ensure the eye tracker connection is not occupied.

1. Plug the USB cable from your eye tracker to the iMotions computer (For Auroras, you will also need to attach the USB cable to the eye tracker).
2. Open iMotions and navigate to the Global Settings - Eye tracking tab. Select Smart Eye Aurora or Smart Eye AI-X from the drop-down menu.
3. Set the Host Address (optional, 'Test Connection' process/button)

- a. For USB connection: 127.0.0.1 (default)
 - b. For EPU connection: 10.0.0.1
4. Click 'OK' to apply settings and return to the main iMotions window where the Eye Tracker Widget should appear and show the connection and eye detection status.



iMotions Eye tracking settings for the AI-X (left), connected AI-X (center), and iMotions Widget (right)

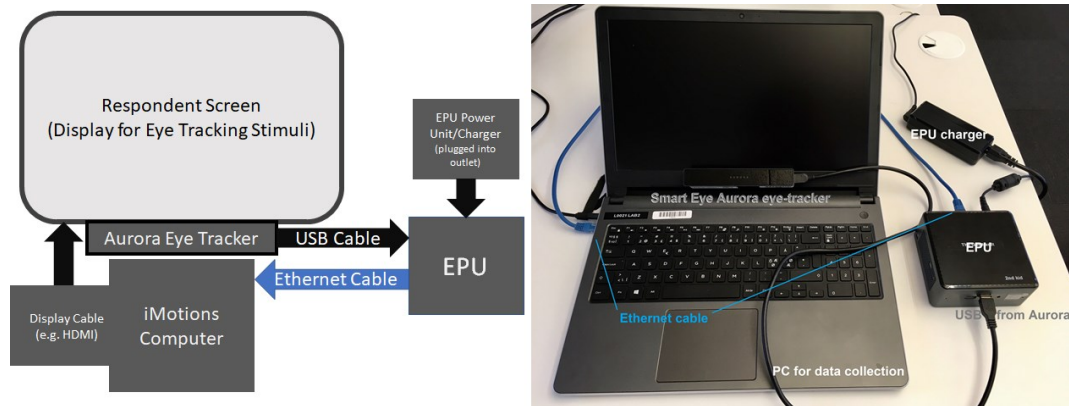
Aurora EPU Setup

- An EPU (External Processing Unit) is provided with the Smart Eye Aurora 120Hz and 250Hz. This will include the:
 - EPU computer - Auxiliary computer for dedicated power and processing for the Aurora
 - Power supply/charger - Separate power for EPU (plugged into outlet and EPU)
 - Ethernet cable (and USB adapter) - Connecting the EPU and iMotions computer
- The EPU is recommended if (1) several other (high-sampling rate) sensors are also used during data collection or (2) Aurora sampling rates are inconsistent or lower than the expected sampling rate.
- [Smart Eye Setup Tool](#) is required on the iMotions computer and these [Aurora EPU files](#) are required on the EPU
- Aurora EPU files are pre-installed but may need to be updated - as described here: [Aurora EPU updates and Recommendations](#)

EPU Hardware Connection

The EPU connection involves the same setup steps (described above), except that the eye tracker USB cable is connected to the EPU and the EPU ethernet is connect to the iMotions computer.

1. Connect the eye tracker USB cable to the EPU.
2. Connect the EPU ethernet port/cable to the iMotions computer (using an ethernet-USB adapter, if necessary).
3. Connect the EPU power supply and power outlet.
4. Press the EPU power button and allow the automatic start up process to complete (usually 1-2 minutes).
5. Perform the steps for [Connecting the Eye Tracker to iMotions](#) with the Host Address 10.0.0.1 (default EPU address) in your iMotions Global Settings - Eye tracking tab.
6. The iMotions computer should automatically connect to the Smart Eye Tracker application on the EPU.
 - a. By default, the EPU is set up with a fixed IP address of 10.0.0.1, running a DHCP server.
 - b. The same IP subnet should be used for the ethernet connection between the iMotions PC and the EPU.
 - c. The iMotions computer should receive the EPU IP address automatically from the EPU DHCP server and subnet.
 - d. The eye tracking sample rate might be limited by computer network load or use of adapters, extenders, port switches, etc. For a full sample rate use a direct Ethernet connection between iMotions computer and the EPU.
7. We recommend turning off the EPU to shut off the Aurora when it is not in use (to prevent extended heating and reducing device wear).
 - a. The EPU can be shut off by holding down the power button until the status light turns off.
 - b. As long as the EPU is powered on, the Aurora will also be on and tracking (unlike direct USB connections, where the Aurora turns off when iMotions is closed).



Smart Eye EPU Setup/Connections



Troubleshooting

Aurora EPU Updates and Troubleshooting (separate Help Center article)

‘Tracker not connected’ or Calibration Errors

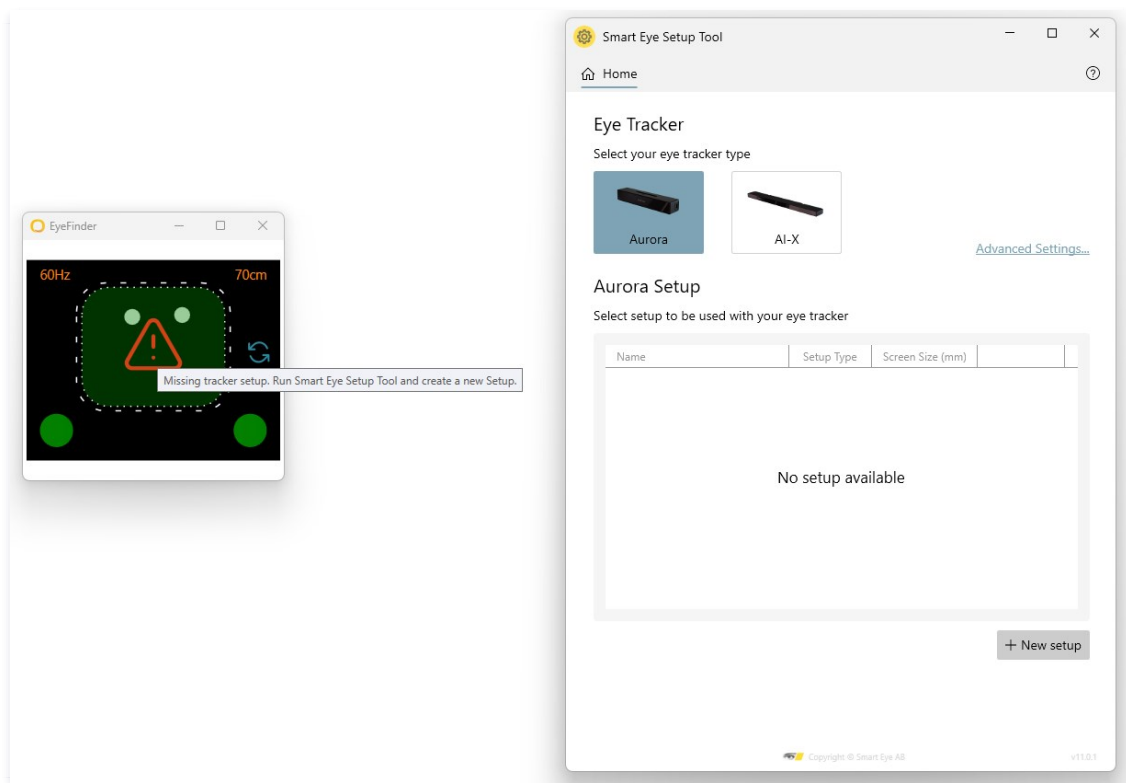
Eye tracker connection and calibration errors can occur when there is insufficient power or security restrictions. This can be resolved by using another, higher power USB port (depending on computer specifications) or with these [Windows Settings Recommendations](#) for USB Power Management and Firewall Exceptions for iMotions and Smart Eye software.

Also verify that the correct Eye Tracker and Host Address are used in your iMotions settings.

'!' Warning in iMotions Eye Tracker Widget

The warning is addressed by [creating a 'setup'](#) in Smart Eye Setup Tool. For iMotions 9.4.1 and Smart Eye Setup Tool 12 (or newer), you can connect to a Aurora or AI-X without a 'setup' in the Smart Eye Setup Tool. If this occurs, a warning (!) is shown in the iMotions Eye Tracker Widget (with more information shown when hovering with your mouse cursor over the warning).

If you are using a version of iMotions earlier than 9.4.1 and a version of the Smart Eye Setup Tool earlier than 12, both cannot be opened at the same time. Using iMotions 9.4.1 (and later) and the Smart Eye Setup Tool 12 (and later) will allow for both to be open at the same time. These software versions were released on November 2nd, 2023, and December 8th, 2023, respectively. If the Aurora-tracker doesn't track the respondent, click the "Re-Profile" button.



Smart Eye Manuals

Smart Eye Aurora Manual ([Smart Eye Aurora Setup website](#))

Smart Eye AI-X Manual ([Smart Eye AI-X Setup website](#))

